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WORLD LOSES MAN OF PEACE

UAE leaders extend condolences on the passing of Pope Francis

VATICAN CITY

Global leaders paid glowing tributes to Pope Francis who died yesterday aged 88.

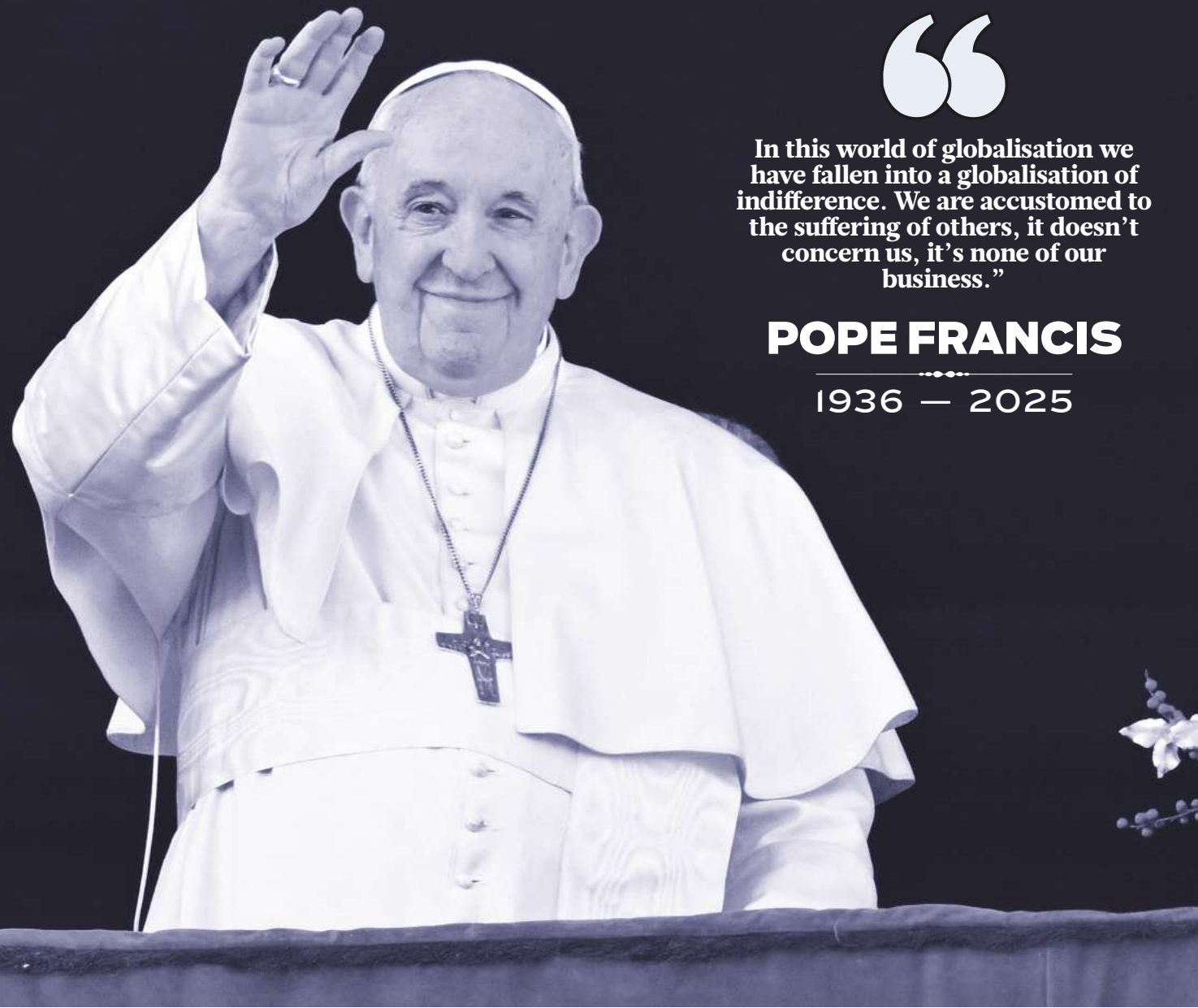
The Argentine pontiff, leader of the Catholic Church since March 2013, spent 38 days being treated for double pneumonia at Rome's Gemelli hospital before seeming to recover and leaving the facility on March 23.

His death came just a day after he delighted the crowds of worshippers at the Vatican on Easter Sunday with an appearance on the balcony at Saint Peter's Basilica.

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan wrote on X, "I extend my deepest condolences to Catholics around the world on the passing of Pope Francis, who dedicated his life to promoting the principles of peaceful coexistence and understanding. May he rest in peace."

His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, posted on X, "We are deeply saddened to hear of the passing of His Holiness Pope Francis @Pontifex, a great leader whose compassion and commitment to peace touched countless lives. His legacy of humility and interfaith unity will continue to inspire many communities around the world." — Agencies

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“

In this world of globalisation we have fallen into a globalisation of indifference. We are accustomed to the suffering of others, it doesn't concern us, it's none of our business.”

POPE FRANCIS

1936 — 2025

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Abu Dhabi discovers first major Iron Age cemetery in Al Ain

3,000-year-old necropolis site includes more than a hundred tombs

ABU DHABI

BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

The first major Iron Age cemetery in the UAE, a 3,000-year-old necropolis found in Al Ain region, was unearthed by DCT (Department of Culture and Tourism) Abu Dhabi's Archaeology Section of the Historic Environment Department. The site likely includes more than one hundred tombs containing an array of grave goods, and casts a new light on a previously unknown chapter of the UAE's rich heritage.

All the tombs found so far were looted in antiquity. The human remains were found in a fragile condition and a team of forensic archaeologists, including an osteoarchaeologist, was present to ensure that all human remains were treated with care and respect.



A few small pieces of gold jewellery that escaped looters' attention suggest what might once have been found. Despite this, impressive burial goods include richly decorated items as part of the afterlife package, displaying high-quality craftsmanship

in a range of media including pottery, carved soft-stone, and metalwork. Drinking sets include spouted vessels, bowls, and small cups, alongside numerous copper-alloy weaponry, such as spearheads and caches of arrowheads.

These last ones often show traces of preserved wood and filaments from their shafting, and one example seems to preserve traces of the quiver that used to contain them. Numerous more personal items have also been found, such as shell cosmetic containers, bead necklaces and bracelets, rings, and razors.

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